

D720

Student Teaching II in Special Education

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

Method © 2026 Erik Daniel Lindquist — Course Mastery Coach, armored drill. Items drafted with AI assistance under his direction.

How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer _____	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
-----------------------------	---	------------------------	----------------------------------

Items

1.

A school sends report cards every nine weeks. A student's IEP says goal progress will be reported with report cards. The case manager coaches the robotics team and has 22 students. By June, the family has had only one progress report, at the annual review. What is the problem?

- A. Nothing; once a year at the annual review is enough.
- B. The family should have received progress reports each quarter, matching report cards.
- C. Only a report at the end of each semester is needed.
- D. Reports are optional if the case manager is busy.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A school sends report cards every six weeks for a 36-week year. If IEP progress is reported with report cards, how many progress reports should a family receive?

- A. 6
- B. 4
- C. 1
- D. 36

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3.

A sixteen-year-old with a learning disability says he wants to be a mechanic. He likes rap music and has a younger brother. His IEP has no transition section. What should the team add?

- A. A music elective to keep him motivated.
- B. Wait until he is a senior.
- C. A note that he likes cars.
- D. Measurable postsecondary goals based on transition assessments, such as completing an automotive program, with services like a job shadow.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A transition goal reads: “The student will think about college.” What is wrong with it?

- A.** It should be about employment only.
- B.** It is fine because college is a real option.
- C.** It needs a grade-level reading score.
- D.** It is not a measurable postsecondary outcome, such as enrolling in a specific program after graduation.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5.

A ninth grader with an emotional disability has been suspended for 8 days this year. The school now proposes a 5-day suspension for fighting near the bus loop. The fight started over a borrowed phone charger. What must happen?

- A.** Expel him since he has 13 days.
- B.** Hold a manifestation determination review within 10 school days of the decision.
- C.** Suspend him; no review is needed for 5 days.
- D.** Review only if the fight caused injury.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A review finds the student’s behavior was a manifestation of his disability. What generally happens next?

- A.** Conduct or review an FBA and behavior plan and generally return him to his placement.
- B.** Move him to a new school automatically.
- C.** Proceed with the suspension as planned.
- D.** End his IEP.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7.

A student teacher notices that a student's IEP requires 30 minutes of speech therapy weekly, but the speech therapist has been out for six weeks and no services were made up. The school is small and the principal is new. What is the ethical step?

- A. Stay silent to avoid conflict.
- B. Wait for the new principal to notice.
- C. Raise the missed services with the cooperating teacher and case manager so the school can arrange make-up services and inform the family.
- D. Post about it on social media.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8.

A special education teacher has these tasks this week: an evaluation due Friday by law, a student safety plan to update today, copying next month's worksheets, and redecorating a bulletin board. She coaches cheer on Tuesdays. In what order should she handle them?

- A. Evaluation, then safety plan.
- B. Safety plan, evaluation, worksheets, bulletin board.
- C. Skip cheer to do all four at once tonight.
- D. Bulletin board first, since it is quick.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9.

A team must choose a reading intervention for a sixth grader with weak decoding. One program is popular on social media with bright games; another has several strong studies with middle schoolers who struggle to decode. The school librarian likes a third, which has no research. Which should the team choose?

- A. The program with strong studies for middle school decoding.
- B. The popular game-based program.
- C. Any program, since all interventions work the same.
- D. The librarian's favorite.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10.

A fourth grader who arrived from another country eight months ago is reading below grade level in English. She reads well in her first language and has a pet parrot. A teacher wants to refer her for a learning disability. What should the team do first?

- A.** Wait five years before any support.
- B.** Test her only in English.
- C.** Compare her with similar English learners and consider language acquisition before any referral.
- D.** Refer her right away for a reading disability.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

An English learner reads poorly in both her first language and English, and she lags well behind similar English learners despite good instruction. What does this pattern suggest?

- A.** Poor motivation.
- B.** Nothing, since English learners are never referred.
- C.** Only a language difference.
- D.** A possible disability that should be evaluated.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12.

The IEP team plans to reduce a student's resource-room time from 60 to 30 minutes a day. The student has made strong gains and likes chess. The case manager plans to tell the parents at pickup next month. What is required?

- A.** Offer chess club instead of resource time.
- B.** Make the change and notify them at the annual review.
- C.** Give the parents prior written notice explaining the proposed change and the reasons before it happens.
- D.** Tell them at pickup; informal notice is fine.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer B Concept 1

A school sends report cards every nine weeks. A student's IEP says goal progress will be reported with report cards. ~~The case manager coaches the robotics team and has 22 students.~~ By June, the family has had only one progress report, at the annual review. What is the problem?

Target word: progress-reporting frequency **Decides:** IEP ties reporting to report cards.

A	Inverted operation	Annual review is not the progress-reporting schedule.
B	Correct	Progress reporting must follow the IEP schedule.
C	Wrong stem number	Twice a year does not match four report cards.
D	Camouflage	Answers the workload detail.

2. Answer A Concept 1 • transfer

A school sends report cards every six weeks for a 36-week year. If IEP progress is reported with report cards, how many progress reports should a family receive?

Target word: compute count **Decides:** $36 \div 6$.

A	Correct	$36 \div 6 = 6$ reports.
B	Confusion set	The typical quarterly count, not six-week periods.
C	Inverted operation	Treats the annual review as the only report.
D	Wrong stem number	The number of weeks.

3. Answer D Concept 2

A sixteen-year-old with a learning disability says he wants to be a mechanic. ~~He likes rap music and has a younger brother.~~ His IEP has no transition section. What should the team add?

Target word: transition requirement **Decides:** Age 16 requires measurable postsecondary goals and services.

A	Camouflage	Answers the music detail.
B	Inverted operation	The requirement applies by 16.
C	Dropped element	Not a measurable goal or service.
D	Correct	IDEA requires measurable goals and services by 16.

4. Answer D Concept 2 • transfer

A transition goal reads: "The student will think about college." What is wrong with it?

Target word: reverse: bad transition goal **Decides:** Not measurable, not postsecondary outcome.

A	Absolute language	Education or training goals are required too.
B	Adjacent category	A real option still needs a measurable goal.
C	Confusion set	An academic annual goal, not a postsecondary goal.
D	Correct	Transition goals state measurable outcomes after high school.

5. Answer B Concept 3

A ninth grader with an emotional disability has been suspended for 8 days this year. The school now proposes a 5-day suspension for fighting near the bus loop. ~~The fight started over a borrowed phone charger.~~ What must happen?

Target word: manifestation determination trigger **Decides:** $8 + 5 = 13$ days exceeds 10 — a change of placement.

A	Inverted operation	The total triggers protections, not automatic expulsion.
B	Correct	More than 10 cumulative days can be a change of placement, triggering review.
C	Dropped element	Drops the 8 days already served.
D	Camouflage	Answers the fight detail; injury does not decide.

6. Answer A Concept 3 • transfer

A review finds the student's behavior was a manifestation of his disability. What generally happens next?

Target word: reverse: outcome of a yes finding **Decides:** Return and address behavior.

A	Correct	A yes finding shifts to behavior support, with limited exceptions.
B	Absolute language	Placement changes require team decision, with narrow exceptions.
C	Inverted operation	That is the path for a no finding.
D	Adjacent category	The finding does not remove eligibility.

7. Answer C Concept 4

A student teacher notices that a student's IEP requires 30 minutes of speech therapy weekly, but the speech therapist has been out for six weeks and no services were made up. ~~The school is small and the principal is new.~~ What is the ethical step?

Target word: advocacy **Decides:** Services are not delivered.

A	Inverted operation	Silence lets the student lose services.
B	Camouflage	Answers the principal detail.
C	Correct	Advocacy through proper channels is an ethical duty.
D	Adjacent category	Public posting is not a proper channel and breaks confidentiality.

8. Answer B Concept 5

A special education teacher has these tasks this week: an evaluation due Friday by law, a student safety plan to update today, copying next month's worksheets, and redecorating a bulletin board. ~~She coaches cheer on Tuesdays.~~ In what order should she handle them?

Target word: task priority **Decides:** Safety and legal deadlines first.

A	Confusion set	Safety comes before a Friday deadline due today.
B	Correct	Safety first, legal deadline next, then routine tasks.
C	Camouflage	Answers the coaching detail; not prioritizing.
D	Inverted operation	Puts the lowest priority first.

9. Answer A Concept 6

A team must choose a reading intervention for a sixth grader with weak decoding. One program is popular on social media with bright games; another has several strong studies with middle schoolers who struggle to decode. ~~The school librarian likes a third, which has no research.~~ Which should the team choose?

Target word: evidence-based choice **Decides:** Research support for this need and age.

A	Correct	Evidence-based practice fits the need and population.
B	Adjacent category	Popularity is not evidence.
C	Absolute language	Evidence differs between programs.
D	Camouflage	Answers the librarian detail.

10. Answer C Concept 7

A fourth grader who arrived from another country eight months ago is reading below grade level in English. She reads well in her first language ~~and has a pet parrot.~~ A teacher wants to refer her for a learning disability. What should the team do first?

Target word: referral decision **Decides:** Short time learning English; strong first-language reading.

A	Absolute language	Support should begin now.
B	Dropped element	Drops first-language information.
C	Correct	Language difference must be ruled out.
D	Inverted operation	Confuses language learning with disability.

11. Answer D Concept 7 · transfer

An English learner reads poorly in both her first language and English, and she lags well behind similar English learners despite good instruction. What does this pattern suggest?

Target word: reverse: when referral fits **Decides:** Difficulty across languages and vs. peers.

A	Adjacent category	The pattern does not point to motivation.
B	Absolute language	English learners can have disabilities.
C	Inverted operation	Language difference alone would not explain first-language weakness.
D	Correct	Problems across both languages and behind similar peers point beyond language acquisition.

12. Answer C Concept 8

The IEP team plans to reduce a student's resource-room time from 60 to 30 minutes a day. ~~The student has made strong gains and likes chess.~~ The case manager plans to tell the parents at pickup next month. What is required?

Target word: notice before change **Decides:** A change in services.

A	Camouflage	Answers the chess detail.
B	Inverted operation	Notice must come before, not after.
C	Correct	Written notice is required before changes to services.
D	Dropped element	Drops the written requirement.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owled.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	4	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	2	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	5	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	10	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	5	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	3	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	7	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	IEP progress reporting	Families must get reports on progress toward IEP goals as the IEP specifies — commonly at least as often as report cards for students without disabilities.	Reporting IEP progress only at the annual review.	How often families hear about IEP goals.
2	Transition planning	Under IDEA, IEPs in effect by age 16 (earlier in some states) must include measurable postsecondary goals for training or education, employment, and (where needed) independent living, based on transition assessments, with services to reach them.	Writing vague career wishes or waiting until senior year.	A secondary-aged student's IEP.
3	Manifestation determination	Within 10 school days of a decision to change the placement of a student with a disability for a conduct violation, the team must decide whether the behavior was caused by, or directly related to, the disability, or was the direct result of the school failing to carry out the IEP.	Suspending a student with an IEP long-term with no review.	Discipline that would remove a student more than 10 school days.
4	Advocacy as an ethical duty	Special educators have an ethical duty to advocate when students are not receiving the services in their IEPs, through proper channels.	Staying silent to avoid conflict with administrators or colleagues.	IEP services missing or not delivered.
5	Prioritizing a special education workload	Protect student safety and legal deadlines (evaluations, IEP dates) first, then schedule routine tasks — a calendar and boundaries prevent crises and burnout.	Handling tasks in the order they arrive, or working without limit.	A heavy caseload with overlapping deadlines.
6	Selecting evidence-based practices	Choose interventions with solid research support for the student's need and age, and check that they fit the student.	Choosing an intervention because it is popular or feels fun.	Several program options for the same need.
7	Language difference vs. disability	Before referring an English learner for a disability, compare with similar peers, consider language acquisition, and check the student's first-language skills.	Assuming slow English progress means a disability.	An English learner struggling in class.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
8	Prior written notice	Schools must give families written notice before proposing or refusing to change a student's identification, evaluation, placement, or services.	Changing services informally and telling families later.	A plan to change or end a service.

Course scope (public description): Student Teaching II is the final part of a two-part series and is a mandatory course for all candidates seeking initial licensure. The course offers a supervised classroom experience in a real-world setting, allowing candidates to demonstrate professional ethics and dispositions, collaborate with experienced teachers, and implement instructional strategies. Building on the responsibilities and skills developed in Student Teaching I, candidates receive ongoing feedback through observations and a final evaluation. This evaluation assesses activities' relevance and cultural engagement, the effectiveness of teaching each student, the ability to analyze and adjust teaching methods, and the willingness to explore new materials and methods. Successful completion of Student Teaching II is a crucial step in the licensure process, as it determines eligibility for licensure as a professional educator. Additionally, the course features synchronous learning sessions that delve into professional development topics such as professional growth opportunities, ethical decision making, and self-care. Candidates must attend the required synchronous learning sessions in addition to their classroom placement.